



Introduction to Brain and Cognition

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READING ASSIGNMENT: Chapter 2, Reisberg (2019). Cognition

Chapter 2: The Neural Basis for Cognition

- Focus of the IBC course is exploring intellectual foundation of almost every aspect of human experience.
 - Most of cognitive psychology is concerned with the functions that our brains make possible, and not the brain itself.
 - Our understanding of cognition has certainly been enhanced by the study of the brain.
- Cognitive Neuroscience
 - Is the effort toward understanding our mental functioning through close study of the brain and nervous system.
 - Mental achievements are a result of the coordinated functioning of many different brain regions.

Chapter 2: The Neural Basis for Cognition

- Capgras Syndrome
 - is fully able to recognize the people in her world — her husband, her parents, her friends — but is utterly convinced that these people are not who they appear to be. The real has been kidnapped (or worse). The person now in view, therefore, must be a fraud of some sort, impersonating the (allegedly) absent person.
 - Leads to two-systems hypothesis: one for recognition and another for emotional evaluation!
 - Cognitive Psychology studies illuminate the nature of cognitive function and breakdown observed in Capgras Syndrome.
 - Similarly, the disease itself illuminates the nature of the brain and the mind!

Chapter 2: The Neural Basis for Cognition

- Different ways of studying the Brain and Behavior [Blackboard presentation]
 - Empirical Methods
 - Brain and Mind: through Health and Disease
 - Modeling